

20 km of tunnels: do they manage flooding?

A public claim, tested against official sources and rainfall data

THE CLAIM

“...they avoid flooding and damage caused by waters every time it rains.”

Mario Ellul, Public Works Department, as reported by TVM News, 4 July 2025

Said as the department works to extend the network from 16 km to 20 km.

The 20 km is the planned total; the department puts 16 km in use.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*Plausible by design,
but not shown.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

16 km

In use now

Public Works Department, 4 July 2025. A further 4 km is planned.

20 km

The planned total

The headline figure describes the plan, not what is operating.

5-year

Design storm

The European Commission says the system is built for a 5-year storm over 65 km².

2020

Flooding continued

Roads flooded in project localities in September 2020; two more tunnels were planned in 2022.

0

Before-and-after counts

No published flood-incident series found, so the effect cannot be measured.

FAIR TO SAY

The tunnels are real and were built to reduce flooding, and the department maintains them every year. This check is about the 20 km and the words “every time it rains”.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Flood incidents by locality, 2005 to date.

☐ Design storm for each catchment.

☐ Operating length of each tunnel.

☐ The source of the 20 km figure.